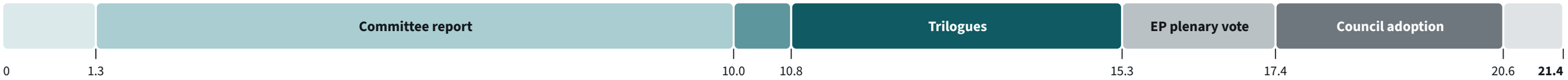
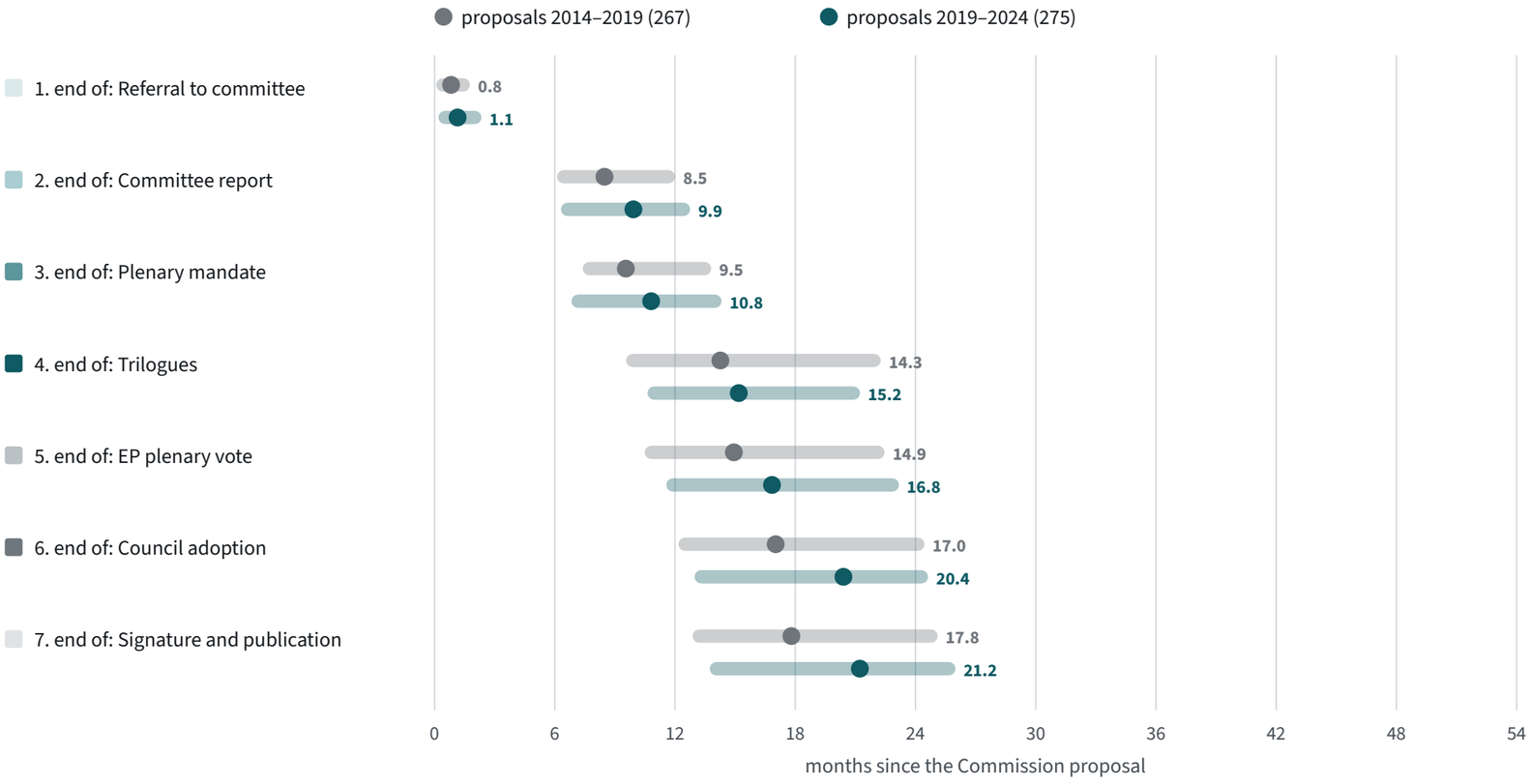
How long an EU law takes, phase by phase

Ordinary legislative procedure, files agreed at first reading after trilogues and published in the Official Journal, by the term in which the Commission proposed them. Months since the proposal: dot = median, bar = middle half of the files.

Typical path, proposals of the 2019–2024 term: month in which each step ends (median, 257 files)



Phases short in most files can still move the median a lot: in April 2019 and 2024 Parliament voted many files before legal-linguistic revision, the Council adopted them 3–8 months later.



Each phase on its own (median months, middle half)

	2014–2019	2019–2024
Referral to committee	**0.8** 0.4–1.4	**1.1** 0.5–2.0
Committee report	**7.4** 5.5–10.1	**8.1** 5.5–11.5
Plenary mandate	**0.6** 0.4–0.9	**0.5** 0.4–1.0
Trilogues	**3.9** 2.1–8.0	**4.3** 2.7–7.1
EP plenary vote	**1.6** 0.7–2.1	**1.8** 1.1–2.6
Council adoption	**0.9** 0.6–1.4	**0.7** 0.5–1.2
Signature and publication	**0.8** 0.5–1.2	**0.8** 0.5–1.1

Source: EP Legislative Observatory (OEIL), key events of 1080 COD files proposed 2014–2026, as of 27 Oct 2026; own calculation. Not an official statistic. · Steffen Zimmermann, git-z0man.github.io/eu-regulation-timeline, CC BY 4.0